TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · LEARN

Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER Beats are grouped into bars; beat 1 of every bar is the strongest.

1 Strong beats ★☆☆

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar. In 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4 ● ● | ● ● |

3/4 ● ● ● | ● ● ● |

4/4 ● ● ● ● | ● ● ● ● |

2 Name the signs ★☆☆

Write the name of each sign and what it tells you.

SIGN	NAME	IT TELLS YOU
		
		
		

3 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold. The first bar is done.



4 Slow to fast ★☆☆

Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4). Then set a metronome to each and walk to it.

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

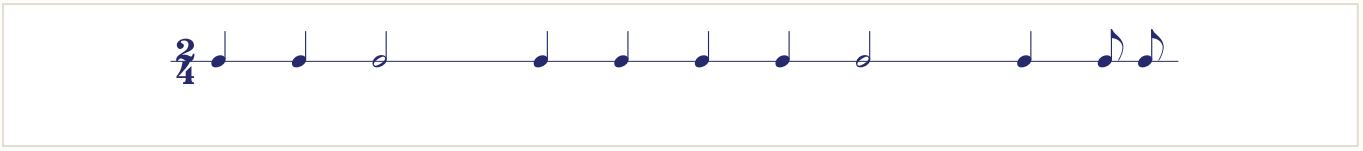
TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · USE

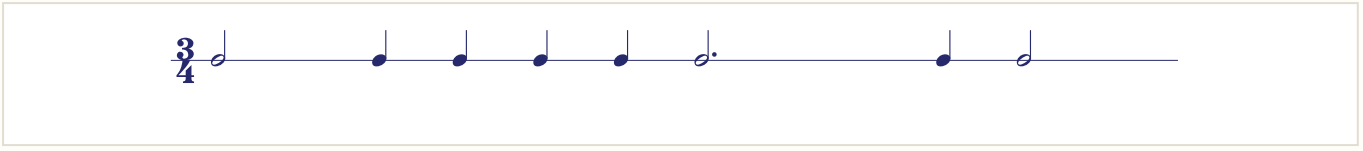
Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER A long note still has every one of its beats counted.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

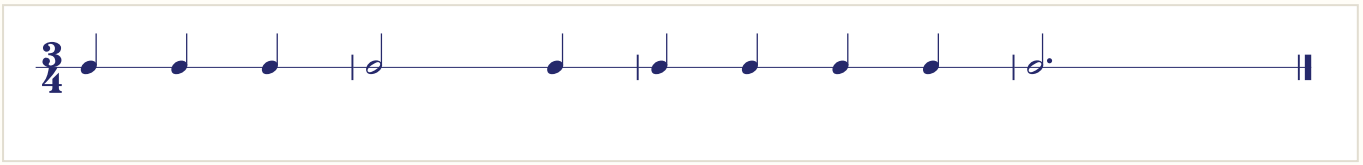
Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.





2 Spot the mistake ★★☆

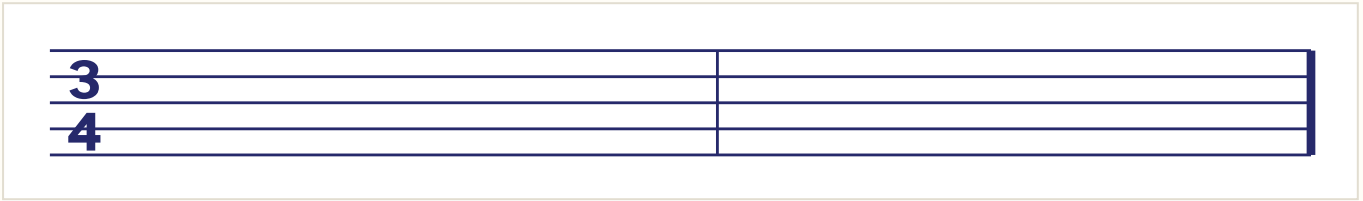
One bar has the wrong number of beats. Circle it and write how many beats it has.



beats in the wrong bar ☐

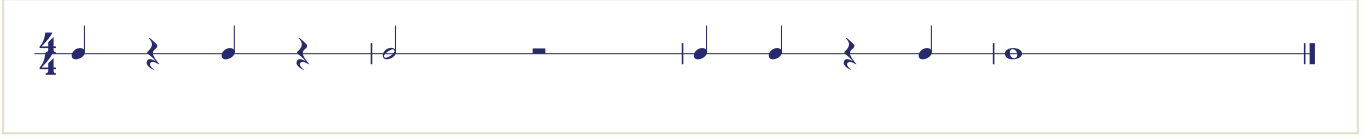
3 Make your own ★★★

Write two bars of 3/4 using crotchets and minims. Clap them while counting, then play them on one note.



4 Clap and count ★☆☆

Set a metronome to ♩ = 60. Clap on the notes, open your hands on the rests, count aloud. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · LEARN

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Each plain note lasts half as long as the one above it; every note has a rest of the same length.

1 Name, beats and rest

★☆☆

Write each note's name and beats (crotchet = 1 beat), then draw the rest of the same length. The first row is done.

NOTE	NAME	BEATS	REST
	semibreve	**4**	
			
			
			
			
			

2 Draw it

★★☆

Draw one note for each length (crotchet = 1 beat).

2 beats	½ beat	3 beats	4 beats

3 The other name

★☆☆

Write the other name for each note. The first is done.

NAME	ALSO CALLED
semibreve	**whole note**
minim	
crotchet	
quaver	
semiquaver	

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

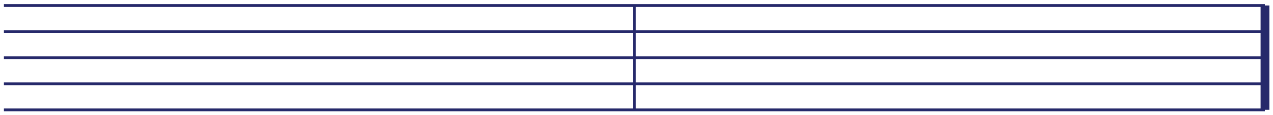
TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · USE

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Below the middle line, stems go up on the right; above it, down on the left.

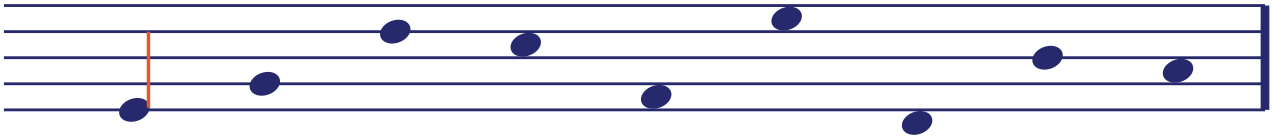
1 Rests on the staff ★☆☆

Draw a semibreve rest in the first bar (it hangs below the fourth line) and a minim rest in the second (it sits on the middle line).



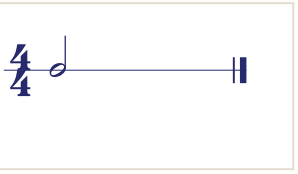
2 Draw the stems ★★☆

Turn every head into a crotchet: add a stem going the right way. The first is done.

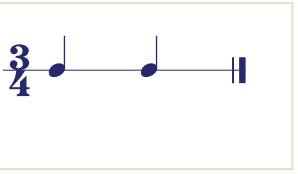


3 Finish with a rest ★★☆

Each bar is short. Complete it with one rest.



rest ☐



rest ☐



rest ☐



rest ☐

4 Which did you hear? ★★☆

Someone claps one rhythm from each row (or play it in the online Library). Circle A, B or C.

A 

B 

C 

A 

B 

C 

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

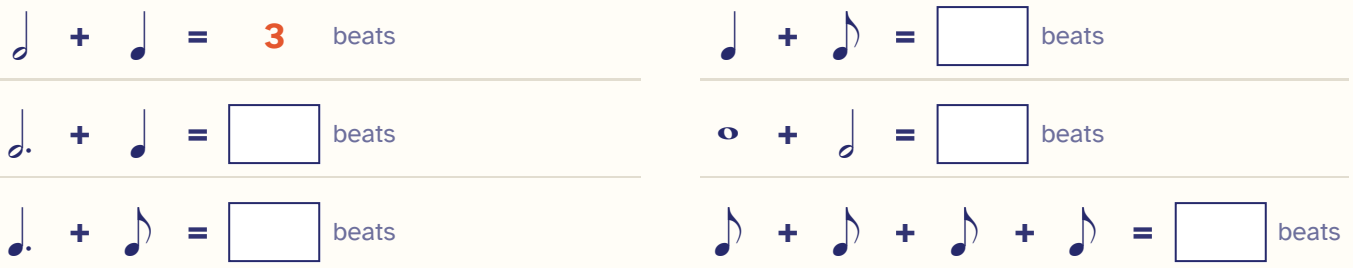
TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · LEARN

How long is a note?

REMEMBER A dot adds half the note's value; a tie joins two notes of the same pitch into one sound.

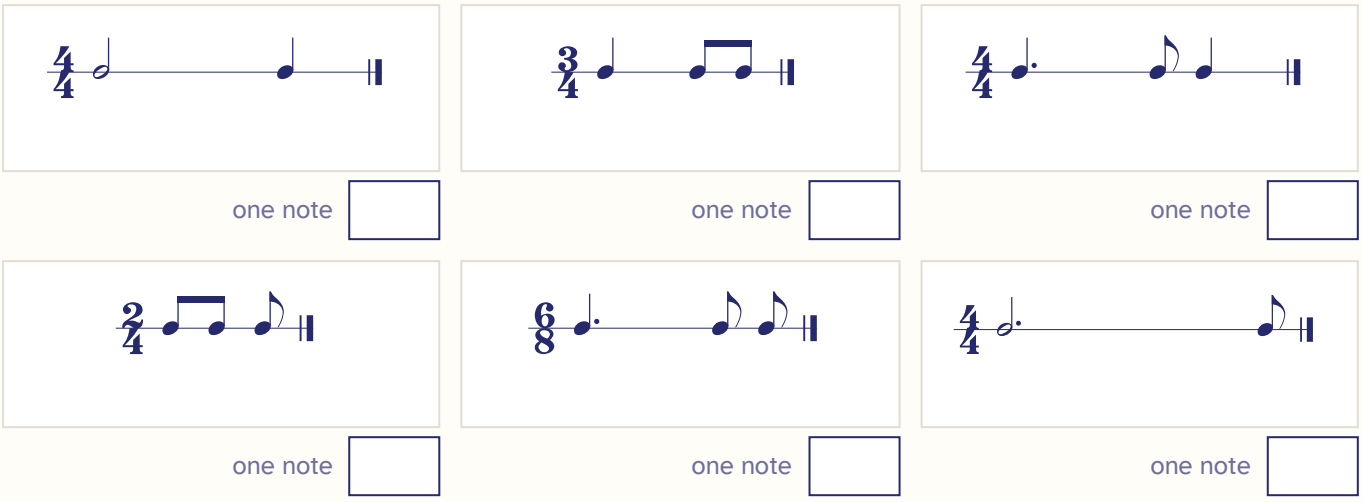
1 Note sums ★☆☆

Add up the beats (crotchet = 1 beat). The first one is done.



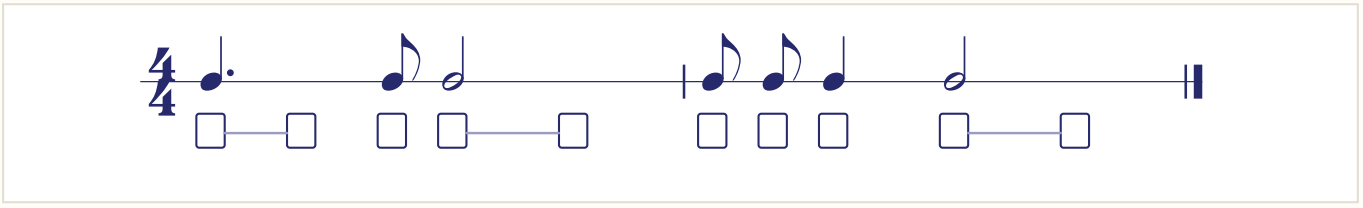
2 Complete the bar ★★☆

Each bar is one note short. Write the one note that completes it.



3 Dots and ties: count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box.



Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · USE

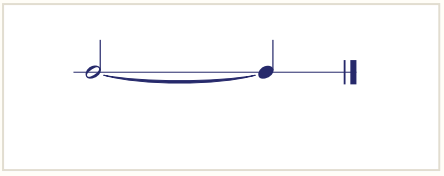
How long is a note?

REMEMBER A tie can cross a bar line; a dot cannot.

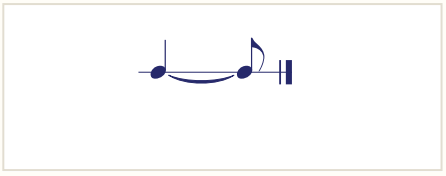
1 Tie or dot?

★★☆

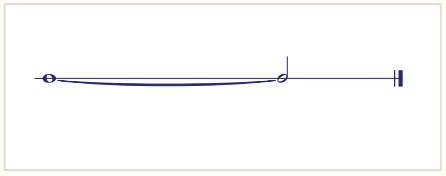
Each tie makes one sound. Write the one dotted note that lasts the same.



dotted note ☐



dotted note ☐

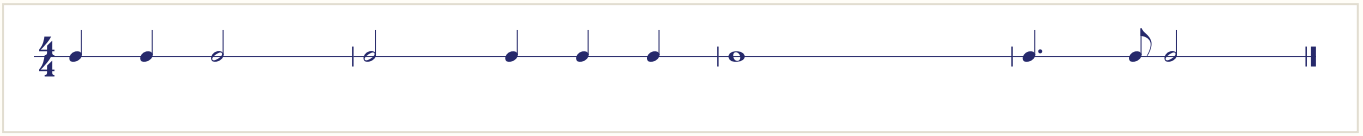


dotted note ☐

2 Spot the mistake

★★☆

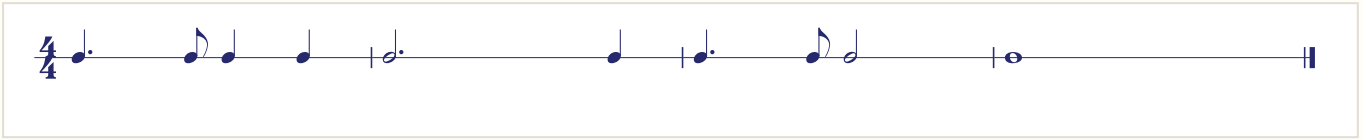
One bar does not add up to four beats. Circle it and correct it.



3 Clap and count

★☆☆

Clap the dotted rhythms, counting the "&" inside each dotted crotchet. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a dotted minim		
a dotted crotchet		
a tie		
a rest of one whole bar		

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · LEARN

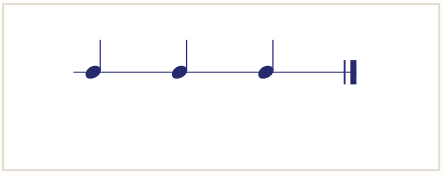
Time signatures

REMEMBER Top number: how many counts in a bar. Bottom number: which note is one count.

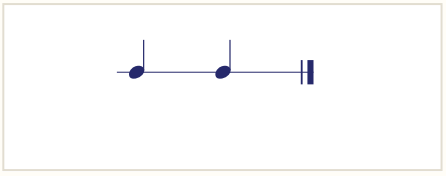
1 Which time signature?

★☆☆

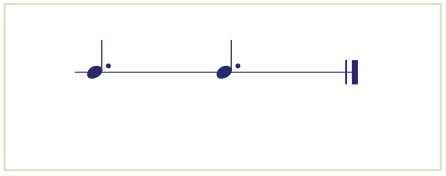
Each line is one full bar. Write a time signature that fits.



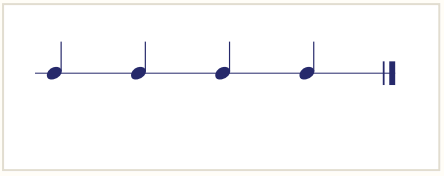
time signature ☐



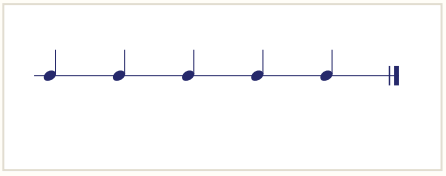
time signature ☐



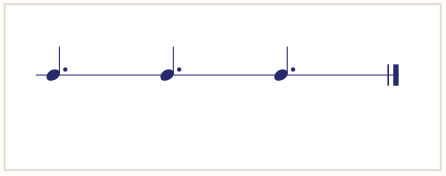
time signature ☐



time signature ☐



time signature ☐



time signature ☐

2 Simple or compound?

★★☆

Circle simple or compound, then write how many beats are in each bar.

$\frac{3}{4}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{6}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐
$\frac{2}{2}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{9}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐
$\frac{4}{4}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{12}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐
$\frac{3}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{6}{4}$	simple · compound	beats ☐

3 What does it mean?

★☆☆

Complete each sentence.

In 3/4 there are ☐ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

In 6/8 there are ☐ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

C means the same as ☐ ; ¢ means the same as ☐ .

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · USE

Time signatures

REMEMBER In compound time each beat is a dotted note, divided into three.

1 Add the bar lines

★★☆

Draw a bar line after every full bar, and a final bar line at the end.



2 Beam them

★★★

The same six quavers in two time signatures. Join them with beams to show the beats: in twos for 3/4, in threes for 6/8.



3 beats

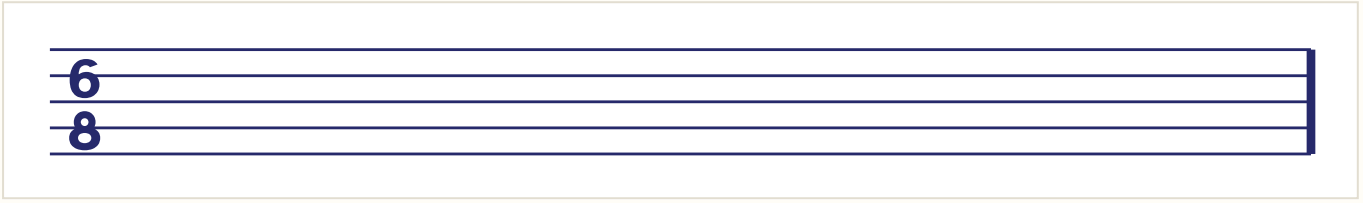


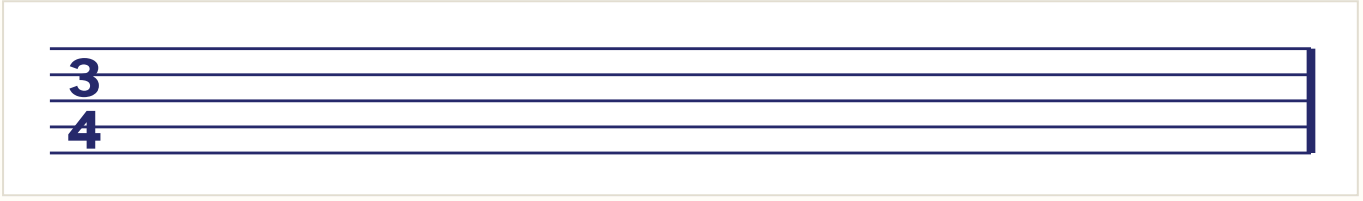
2 beats

3 Make your own

★★★

Write one bar of 6/8 and one bar of 3/4 with six quavers each, beamed correctly. Clap both and feel the difference.





Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · RHYTHM · LEARN

Rhythm

REMEMBER Beams join the notes of one beat, so the beats stay visible.

1 Good grouping?

★★☆

Circle ✓ if the grouping shows the beats, × if it hides one.



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×

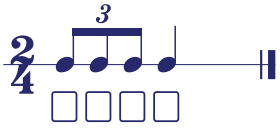


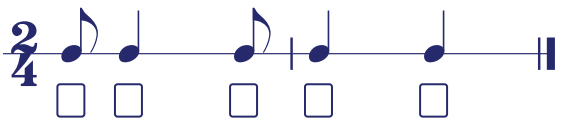
✓ ×

2 Count it

★★☆

Write a count in every box: a triplet, then a syncopation.

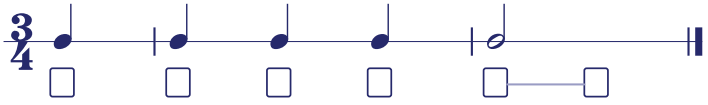




3 The upbeat

★★☆

This piece starts on beat 3. Write a count in every box. Then: how many beats does the last bar need?



beats in the last bar ☐

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · RHYTHM · USE

Rhythm

REMEMBER Swing: pairs of quavers written evenly, played long–short.

1 Swing ★☆☆

Which line shows how swung quavers are played? Circle A or B, then play both and hear the difference.

A



B



2 Clap and count ★★☆

Clap each line with a metronome while counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.

6/8



triplets and semiquavers



syncopation



3 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
an upbeat (anacrusis)		
a triplet		
a syncopation		
swing marked at the top		

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 13.

1 Name the notes ★☆☆

Write the name of each note.



2 How many beats? ★☆☆

Crotchet = 1 beat.





3 Time signatures ★★☆

Write a time signature for each bar, then circle the compound ones.



time signature ☐



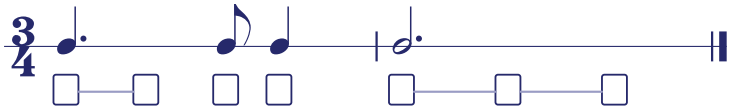
time signature ☐



time signature ☐

4 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box.



5 True or false? ★★☆

Circle T or F.

A tie joins two notes of different pitches.	T	F
6/8 has two beats in a bar.	T	F
In 4/4, a beam may cross the middle of the bar.	T	F

Score ☐ **/ 20**

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
pulse, tempo and strong beats	☐	☐	☐	p. 36
bar lines and repeat signs	☐	☐	☐	p. 36
note and rest values	☐	☐	☐	p. 37
dots and ties	☐	☐	☐	p. 38
simple time signatures	☐	☐	☐	p. 39
compound time (6/8)	☐	☐	☐	p. 40
grouping with beams	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
upbeats	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
triplets	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
syncopation and swing	☐	☐	☐	p. 42

Teacher's note

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Slow to fast: 60, 76, 92, 120. Strong beats on 1; in 4/4 medium on 3. Signs: bar line, double bar line, final bar line, repeat signs. Count: 1 2 3 · 1–2 3 · 1–2–3.
p. 2	Mistake: bar 3 has 4 beats.
p. 3	Draw it: minim, quaver, dotted minim, semibreve. Table: crotchet 1, minim 2, quaver ½, dotted minim 3, semiquaver ¼. Also called: half note, quarter note, eighth note, sixteenth note.
p. 4	Stems: up on the right below the middle line, down on the left above it, either on it. Rests: minim, crotchet, minim, crotchet.
p. 5	Sums: 1½, 4, 6, 2, 2. Complete: crotchet, crotchet, crotchet, quaver, quaver, quaver.
p. 6	Tie or dot: dotted minim, dotted crotchet, dotted semibreve. Mistake: bar 2 has 5 beats.
p. 8	Beams: 3/4 in three pairs; 6/8 in two groups of three.
p. 7	Time signatures: 3/4, 2/4, 6/8, 4/4, 5/4, 9/8. Compound: 6/8, 9/8, 12/8, 6/4 (beats 2, 3, 4, 2). Simple: 3/4 (3), 2/2 (2), 4/4 (4), 3/8 (3). 3/4: 3 crotchet beats; 6/8: 2 dotted-crotchet beats; C = 4/4, ¢ = 2/2.
p. 9	Grouping: ✓ × ✓ ×. Triplet: 1 & a 2. Syncopation: 1 & & 1 2. Upbeat: 3 · 1 2 3 · 1–2; the last bar needs 2 beats.
p. 10	Swing is played as B.
p. 11	minim, quaver, dotted crotchet, semibreve · 4, 4 · 6/8, 5/4, 9/8 (compound: 6/8 and 9/8) · 1–2 & 3 · 1–2–3 · F, T, F.

Pages with “make your own”, “in your music” and clapping have no single answer: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____